EZRA DANIEL

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EDUCATION

THE OHIO STATE UNIVERSITY — Columbus, OH
Ph.D. in Finance (expected) — 2021 – 2027

CARNEGIE MELLON UNIVERSITY — Pittsburgh, PA
B.S. in Business Administration — 2015 – 2019

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Financial intermediation, behavioral finance, corporate finance

JOB MARKET PAPER

Belief Distortions and Lending Cyclicality: Evidence from Industry-Specialized Banks

This paper studies how industry specialization affects banks' belief formation and lending over the credit cycle. I show that when a specialized bank's preferred industry experiences a stock market runup, the bank expands lending and reduces loan loss provisions without tightening loan terms, despite the fact that industry performance declines from its runup-period peak in the years that follow. Loans originated under these conditions have a 62 basis point higher default rate than comparable loans made by nonspecialized banks to the same industry. Consistent with a diagnostic expectations framework, earnings call sentiment analysis reveals that specialized banks express heightened optimism toward their preferred industries during booms. The results highlight a downside of expertise in financial intermediation: specialization can amplify credit cycles by distorting beliefs.

Presentations: International Behavioral Finance Conference, Chicago, IL (2026); AFA Annual Meeting, Student Poster Session, Washington, DC (2027).

WORK IN PROGRESS

How Banks Responded to the 2023 Interest Rate Shock

This paper studies what the 2023 banking shock cost the banks that survived it. Banks the equity market marked down in March 2023 regained their pre-shock share price and deposit base within a quarter, but not their earning power: net interest margin stands approximately 0.4 points below comparable banks three years later, and the gap is entirely on the funding side rather than the asset side.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

THE OHIO STATE UNIVERSITY, Fisher College of Business — Columbus, OH

Corporate Finance — 8/2024 – 12/2024
Instructor

Investments — Spring 2023, 2025, 2026
Teaching assistant, Prof. Petra Vokata

Corporate Finance — 8/2022 – 12/2022
Teaching assistant, Profs. Bernadette Minton, Michael Weisbach, Karen Wruck

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

GREYCOURT & CO — Pittsburgh, PA
Wealth Manager — 2019 – 2021

REFERENCES

René Stulz (co-chair) — stulz.1@osu.edu
Justin Birru (co-chair) — birru.2@osu.edu
Thomas Flanagan — flanagan.224@osu.edu